

Connect a PostgreSQL Database to Claude Code

A two-minute setup that lets Claude Code read and query your database in plain English, using the Model Context Protocol (MCP).

What you need

- Claude Code installed
- A running PostgreSQL database
- Node.js 18 or higher

The command

```
claude mcp add postgres -- npx -y @modelcontextprotocol/server-postgres
"postgresql://toolbox_user@localhost:5432/toolbox_db"
```

That single line does everything. Here is what each part means:

Part	What it does
claude mcp add postgres	Registers a new MCP server with Claude Code and names it "postgres"
--	Separates Claude's own options from the command that starts the server
npx -y @modelcontextprotocol/ server-postgres	Downloads and runs the official Postgres MCP server on the spot, no separate install. The -y flag skips the confirmation prompt
"postgresql://...toolbox_db "	The connection string that tells the server which database to talk to

The connection string, decoded

```
postgresql://USER@HOST:PORT/DATABASE
```

- **USER** the database user (here, toolbox_user)
- **HOST** where the database lives (localhost means your own machine)
- **PORT** the door it listens on (5432 is the Postgres default)
- **DATABASE** which database to open (toolbox_db)

Verify the connection

After running the command, fully quit and reopen Claude Code, then type /mcp. You should see postgres listed as connected, with its query tool available.

Query in plain English

Now just ask. Claude writes and runs the SQL for you:

- "What tables do I have?"
- "Show me everyone in the employee_salary table."
- "What is the average salary per department?"

Behind the scenes, that last question becomes:

```
SELECT department, AVG(salary) AS avg_salary
FROM employee_salary
GROUP BY department
ORDER BY avg_salary DESC;
```

The official server is read-only, so it inspects your schema and runs SELECT queries safely, without ever changing your data.